Team lead · Quick concepts

Interview revision sheet. Read it the evening before, then test yourself in Interview practice.

Role of a lead

- Prioritise, unblock, communicate; multiply the team's output.
- Assign by skills and capacity; stay involved in P1s.
- Servant leadership: remove blockers and grow people.

Running the team

- Short daily stand-ups: blockers, critical tickets, priorities.
- Clear shift handovers: open issues, actions, escalations, next steps.
- Skills matrix and cross-training to avoid single points of failure.
- RACI: Responsible, Accountable, Consulted, Informed.

Incidents and stakeholders

- Two P1s: prioritise by business impact, get extra help, inform stakeholders.
- Angry client: acknowledge impact, share status and plan, give next update time.
- Major incident bridge: one incident lead, focus on restore, track actions, timed updates.
- Never bypass change control; use the emergency change path.

People management

- Feedback: private, specific, timely, listen, agree next steps.
- Conflict: listen to both, focus on facts and shared goals.
- Mistakes: blameless review of process gaps; support the person to learn.
- Fair performance reviews with evidence from the whole period.

Improving the team

- Automate frequent, repetitive, low-risk tasks first.
- Reserve time for improvements; track time saved.
- Runbooks, knowledge base and KT sessions keep knowledge in the team.
- Show data on overload and propose options (automation, staffing).

Metrics and reporting

- SLA compliance, MTTR, backlog trends, repeat incidents, CSAT, automation gains.
- Weekly report: key incidents, SLAs, trends, risks, improvements, asks.

Interview answers

- STAR stories about leading through a crisis, with measurable results.
- Show leadership without the title: ownership, mentoring, improving process.